The encoding systems supported by mbstring are actually quite numerous: in addition to the most common encodings used today (UTF-8, UTF-16), mbstring provides support for obsolete encodings like UTF-7, a plethora of pre-Unicode multi-byte systems of East Asian origin (e.g., ISO-2022-JP, Big5), and the extended ASCII systems ISO-8859-1, ISO-8859-2, and so on. There are also "encodings" such as Base64, which aren't character encodings (equivalent to ASCII or UTF-8) per se, but binary-to-text transforms to ensure safe transmission of data. To obtain the full list of all supported encodings:

```
print_r(mb_list_encodings());
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => BASE64
    ...
    [77] => CP50221
    [78] => CP50222
)
```

Each string can be used as input to the various mbstring functions that accept an encoding argument (which is most of them). Many encoding systems have more than one name, and mbstring is aware of most (all?) of them. To get the list of known aliases of a particular encoding name, use the following:

```
print_r(mb_encoding_aliases('ASCII'));
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => ANSI_X3.4-1968
    [1] => iso-ir-6
    ...
    [9] => cp367
    [10] => csASCII
)
```